

A classroom pilot on AI use and student thinking

Helping students think with AI — and measuring whether it works.

The problem, in one finding. In a randomized trial published this year in *NEJM AI*, 44 physicians — each with 20 hours of dedicated AI-literacy training — lost 14 points of diagnostic accuracy when exposed to confidently wrong AI output (Qazi et al., 2026; $P < 0.0001$). Training alone did not protect them. Real-time awareness at the moment of use might — and no one has tested it in a classroom.

Supporting literature: Gerlich (2025), $r = -0.75$ between cognitive offloading and critical thinking, $n = 666$ (correlational) · Kabashkin (2025), the Cognitive Atrophy Paradox — an explicit call for monitoring instruments.

THE PROPOSED STUDY

Design	Two-week, two-arm randomized pilot — treatment sees live engagement feedback (FoldSpace); control does not.
Sample	Recruit 60–70 students, attrition-buffered to ~50 completing.
Outcomes	Primary: behavioral engagement. Exploratory: critical-thinking measures, parallel pre/post forms.
Posture	Minimal-risk · consent-gated · local-first — no student data ever leaves the device.

We are not claiming this works. We are claiming it is worth testing rigorously enough that a null result would mean something too.

Research partner

Co-investigator on the pilot — the protocol is yours to strengthen or tear apart.

Teaching & learning

A session for the CITL AI series — evidence, live demonstration, honest limits.

Classroom trial

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